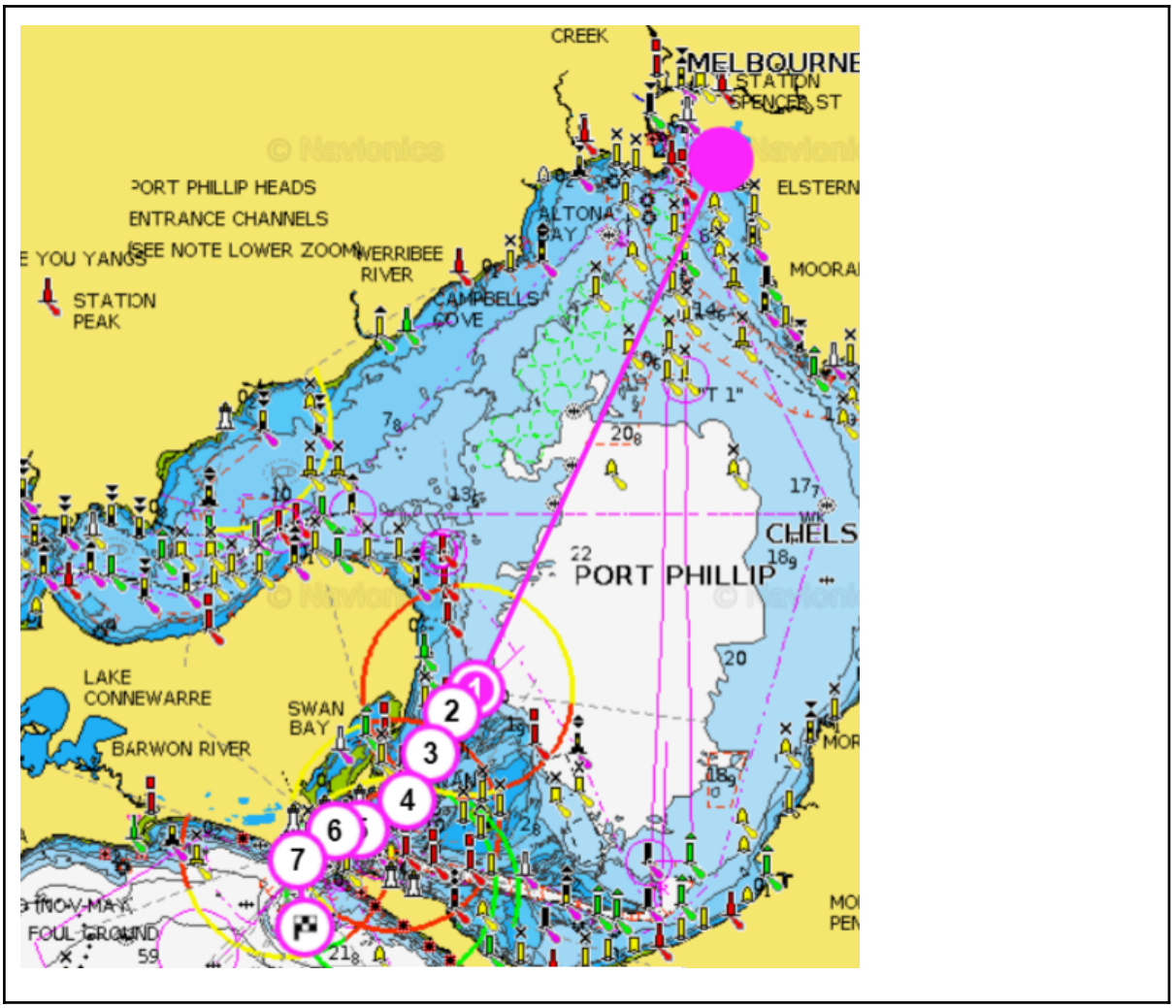
Nov 2026 Passage Plan St Kilda -> Deal Island -> Port Welshpool

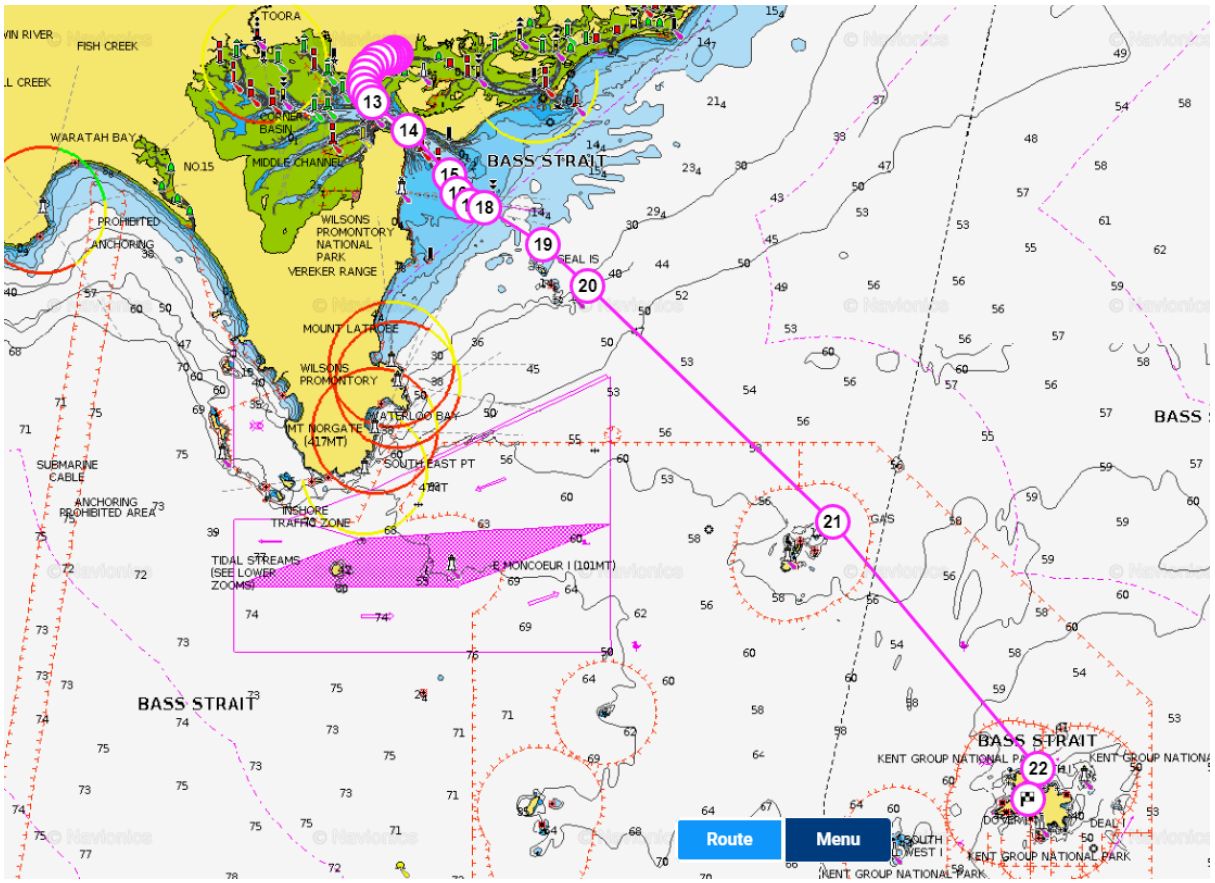
- Summary
  - Crew Details
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  - Weather
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- Weather Forecast Update Times
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  - BOM Meteye

Summary

Saint Kilda to the Kent group. Departing by sail on Saturday 31st of Oct, arriving in Port Welshpool with an ideal date of Friday 6 of Nov, latest is Saturday 7 Nov.







Crew Details

flight pirate	DOB	emergency contact name	emergency contact number
Scott van Heerden (skipper)		Stuart van Heerden	
Rom (co-skipper)	Details in logistics sheet		
Chris (Co-skipper)			
Sam			
Matilda			

Vessel Details

Boat name: Flight

Sail number: S1747

L.O.A: 10.4m

Beam: 3.3m

Draught: 1.8m

Clearance Height: Not sure?

Fuel capacity: 120L

Burn rate: 3.2L per hour @6 knots @2500rpm, range = ~205nm with built in tank

1.9L per hour @5 knots @2000rpm, range = ~290nm

Water capacity: 120L

Water

We will allow 4L per person per day of fresh water.
5 people x 4 Litres x 8 days = 160 Litres.
Flight's inbuilt water tanks hold 120 Litres.
We will also carry 40L water in jerrycans, plus we have about 15L emergency water stashed on the boat.
Tank water is available on Erith island, probs at Deal too if we ask the staff nicely.

Diesel

The entire distance of the trip from St Kilda to Deal Island to Port Welshpool is 250 nm. **We will need to sail, motor sail, use reserves, or drop revs to 2000rpm to extend the range from 225nm to the 250nm we will travel.**

Diesel can be refuelled at Queenscliff at the loading dock. Can pay by card.

Flight can carry 110L of diesel and uses 3.2L/h at 2500rpm, which is enough to motor ~205nm @ 6 knots, or ~290nm at 5 knots

Food

We will mostly rely on the icebox. We may run the fridge on day one if motoring.
We can only run the fridge for 3 hours per solar powered day, because of the power draw.
Foods that don't require refrigeration are preferred.

VHF Channels and Emergency

There is a built in VHF and a hand held VHF on the boat. Marine radio victoria monitors Channels 16 and 67 for voice. Weather warnings broadcast on 67. Coverage is up to 20nm from the coast.

We have a sat phone on board, from which we can call 000 from anywhere.

EPIRBS and PLB's will trigger a response coordinated by the Joint Rescue Coordination Centre, in Canberra.

To cancel a PLB or EPIRB response, turn the EPIRB off immediately, and call 1800 641 792

Weather

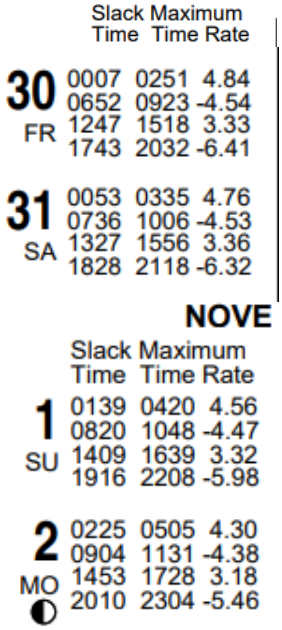
We use predictwind and bom meteye for wind forecasts. The Windy android app offers sea current forecasts.

Use the predictwind offshore app to download and save forecasts, so that you can still review the forecast when out of reception.

Predictwind forecasts are updated twice a day, every 12 hours. By 6am and 6pm, all models have been updated. Exact model update times are at the end of this document.

Part 1: St Kilda to Deal Island

Date	Departing Saturday 31 Oct	**Assumed Speed**	6 knots
From	St Kilda	**Duration**	31 Hrs
To	Deal Island	**Est. Departure Time**	7.00 am (6.30 am for fuel)
Distance to Heads	34nm (6 hrs) (7 hr if fuel up at QC required)	**Est. Heads Crossing**	1.00 pm Saturday 31 Oct
Distance to Deal	156nm (26hrs)	**Est. Arrival Time**	3.00 pm Sunday 1 Nov
Notes	Next Heads slack tide is 18.28 on the 31 Oct, so early morning start, especially if fuel top up required at Queenscliff.		



	Slack Time	Maximum Time	Rate
30 FR	0007	0251	4.84
	0652	0923	-4.54
	1247	1518	3.33
	1743	2032	-6.41
31 SA	0053	0335	4.76
	0736	1006	-4.53
	1327	1556	3.36
	1828	2118	-6.32

NOVE

	Slack Time	Maximum Time	Rate
1 SU	0139	0420	4.56
	0820	1048	-4.47
	1409	1639	3.32
	1916	2208	-5.98
2 MO	0225	0505	4.30
	0904	1131	-4.38
	1453	1728	3.18
	2010	2304	-5.46

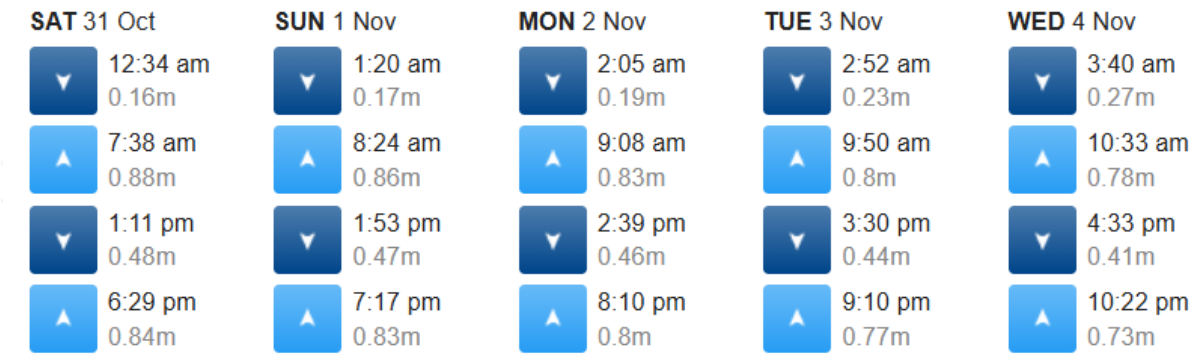
Tides and Currents (Heads crossing)

Our crossing at “The Heads” (entrance to Port Phillip) must be timed at slack tide or a slight and weakening outgoing tide. It takes ~6 hrs to get from St Kilda to the Heads: The passage distance from St Kilda to the Heads is approx 34 nm. 34nm/6kts = 5 hrs 40 mins, plus 1 hr to fuel up if required.

There are two other good options:Depart St Kilda at Saturday 1 am for a Saturday 7.36 am crossing at the heads. Arrive at Deal Sunday 9.40 am. However this requires 2 night shifts.
OR
Depart St Kilda at Saturday 7 am for a Saturday 1.30 pm crossing at the heads

Take particular care of wind against tide, or rough southerly conditions outside the heads presenting difficult times if we need to wait outside

Alternative Ports (tides for West Channel Pile)



- Westernport
- Refuge cove
- Hogan Island

Hazards

The Heads Entrance, water conditions and traffic.

Shipping traffic at night (and the whole way from the Heads to the Deal).

Port Welshpool coast guard:
https://coastguard.com.au/flotilla/vf20-port-welshpool/
Port Welshpool coast guard number: 0428 366 467

Part 2: Deal Island to Port Welshpool

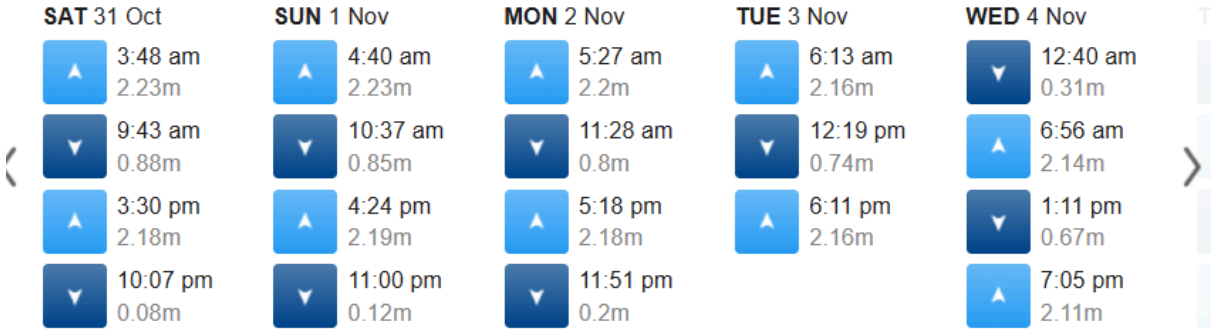
Date	Departing Friday 6th Nov	**Assumed Speed**	6 knots
From	Deal Island	**Duration**	11 Hrs
To	Port Welshpool	**Est. Departure Time**	05:47
Distance	65 NM	**Est. Arrival Time**	16:47

Friday is ideal for the journey to Welshpool from Deal. Saturday can then be used to clean the boat and secure it until the next trip (January 2027). Late bus home 4.50 pm -8.15 pm is then a good option, with Sunday for everyone to get ready for work.
If held up, bus options are the same on Sunday. If weather requires earlier departure week day bus times provided below.

Arriving at Port Welshpool at 16.47 is the low tide (a little before slack tide), so departure time is 5.47 from Deal before the sunrise.

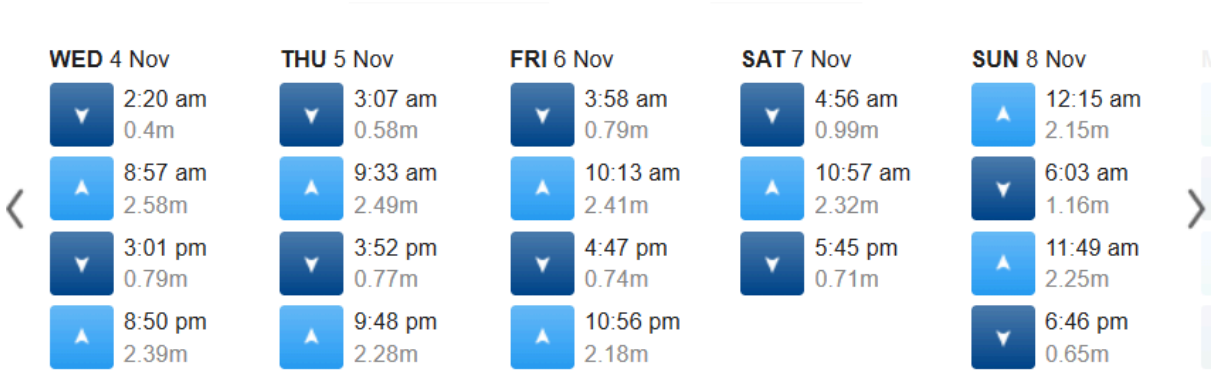
Tides and Currents

http://www.bom.gov.au/australia/tides/
https://www.windy.com/-Currents-currents?currents,2023092823,-39.705,147.530,8
Garden Cove - Nov 2026





Port Welshpool Nov 2026: Tide at the entrance is 40 mins earlier than the tide at Port Welshpool pier.



Alternative Ports

- Refuge Cove
- Tin Mine Cove
- Port Albert
- Hogan Group

Hazards

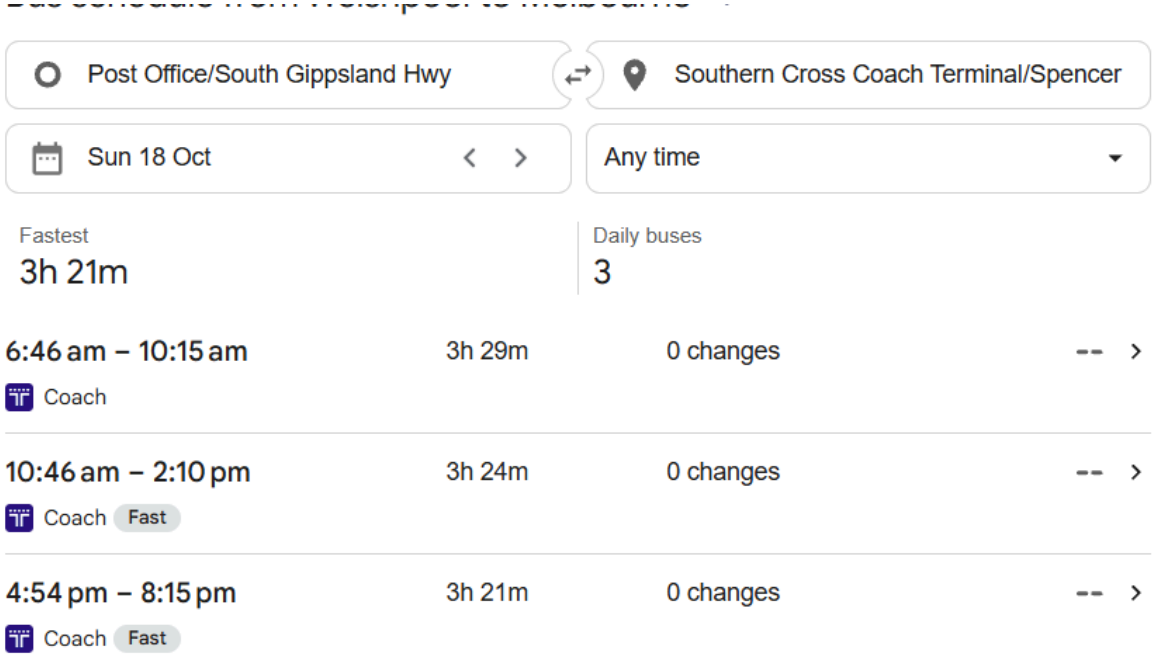
Shipping traffic in Port Welshpool
Wind against tide at Port Welshpool and between Deal/Erith islands
Shipping traffic around prom
Unlit rocky islands

Anchorages

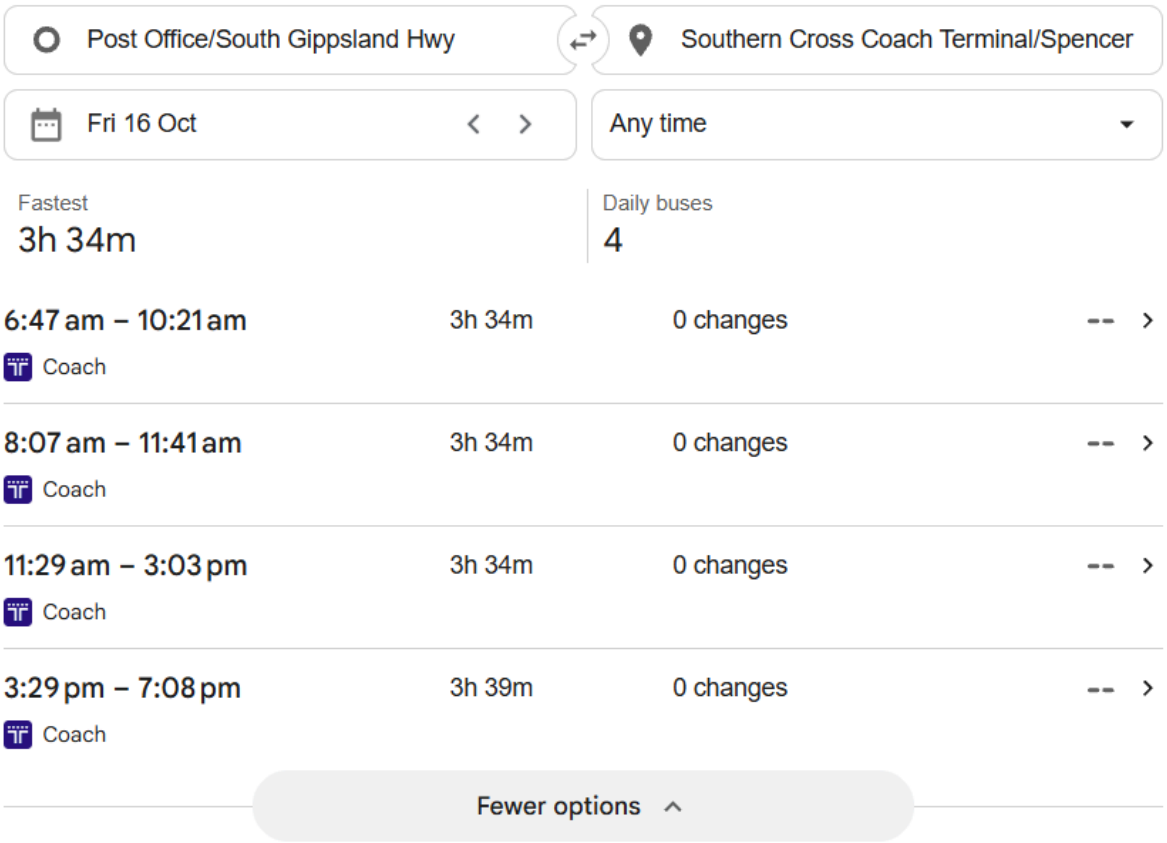
Always dive on the anchor. See Victorian cruising guide for anchorage descriptions.

Bus Times

Saturday and Sunday Bus times are the same.



Week days have 4 buses at slightly different times.



VHF Weather Updates

Radio should be set on dual watch channel 16 and 67 for weather updates and warnings.

VHF Marine Radio Victoria Broadcasts Victorian coastal waters forecasts on VHF channel 67 at 06:48 and 18:48 EST.

Broadcasts an initial weather warning on VHF channel 67 as soon as possible after receipt.

Broadcasts current weather warnings at 00:48, 02:48, 04:48, 06:48, 08:48, 10:48, 12:48, 14:48, 16:48, 18:48, 20:48, 22:48 EST on VHF channel 67 following initial broadcast until notice of cancellation is received from BOM.

Broadcasts notices of cancellation of weather warning as soon as possible after its receipt and at the next scheduled Victorian coastal weather forecast broadcast.

Broadcasts of, and cancellation broadcasts of, weather warnings will be preceded by a SECURITE announcement on VHF channel 16.

Weather Forecast Update Times

Predictwind (**Add 1 hour to the times below for daylight savings:)**

The 1km resolution PWG forecasts are updated at 02:55 and 14:55

The 1km resolution PWE forecasts are updated at 05:10 and 17:10

The 8km resolution PWG forecasts are updated at 02:15 and 14:15
The 8km resolution PWE forecasts are updated at 04:30 and 16:30

The 50km resolution PWG forecasts are updated at 01:55 and 13:55
The 50km resolution PWE forecasts are updated at 04:10 and 16:10

The GFS forecasts are updated at 02:40 and 14:40
The ECMWF forecasts are updated at 05:00 and 17:00

The UKMO forecasts are updated at 03:00 and 15:00

The SPIRE forecasts are updated at 06:30 and 18:30

BOM Meteye

Updated twice a day around 6am and 6pm.

